Metals Market Index MMI

MMi Dashboard

Iron Ore Price Indices

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI62 62% Fe Fines RMB/t

790
1 0.13%
Aug 21st, 2025

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI65 65% Fe Fines RMB/t

902
1.00 0.11%
Aug 21st, 2025

Iron Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI58 58% Fe Fines RMB/t

682
1 0.15%
Aug 21st, 2025

Iron Ore Seaborne (CFR Qingdao)
IOSI62 62% Fe Fines USD/dmt

105.00
0.30 0.29%
Aug 21st, 2025

Iron Ore Seaborne (CFR Qingdao)
IOSI65 65% Fe Fines USD/dmt

119.80
-0.40 -0.33%
Aug 21st, 2025

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPLI 62.5% Fe Lump RMB/t

920
2 0.22%
Week Ending Aug 15th, 2025

Exchange Traded Contracts

DCE Iron Ore 62% Fines
I2509 (September) RMB/t (3pm close)

772.50
3.50 0.46%
Aug 21st, 2025 (3pm close)

SGX Iron Ore (CFR Qingdao) 62% Fe Fines
September 25 USD/dmt

101.20
0.50 0.50%
Aug 21st, 2025 (5.30 pm Print)

SHFE Rebar
RB2510 (Jan) RMB/t

3121
-11 -0.35%
Aug 21st, 2025 (3pm close)

Freight Rates

C3, Tubarao - Qingdao USD/t

23.73
-0.53 -2.2%
Aug 20th, 2025

C5, W. Australia - Qingdao USD/t

9.18
-0.35 -3.7%
Aug 20th, 2025

Steel Price

Steel Rebar (China Domestic) RMB/t

3250
-20 -0.61%
Week Ending Aug 15th, 2025

Inventory Levels

Iron Ore Inventory at Chinese Ports (35)
million tonnes

130.67
1.40 1.08%
Week Ending Aug 15th, 2025

Steel Inventory in China
million tonnes

18.02
-0.04 -0.19%
Week Ending Aug 15th, 2025

Steel Price

Steel HRC (China Domestic) RMB/t

3466
12 0.34%
Week Ending Aug 15th, 2025

IRON ORE PORT STOCK INDEX (IOPI)

Aug 21st, 2025		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [1]						
Index	Fe Content	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOPI62	62% Fe Fines	790	1	0.1%	780	837	683	1063	102.82	0.27	0.3%	100.88	108.98	89.33	140.24
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	682	1	0.1%	680	731	610	963	89.22	0.26	0.3%	88.39	95.78	80.25	128.13
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	902	1	0.1%	892	948	794	1175	117.93	0.30	0.3%	115.87	124.01	104.47	155.37

IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX (IOSI)

Aug 21st, 2025		CFR Qingdao, USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOSI62	62% Fe Fines	105.00	0.30	0.29%	102.00	110.07	89.79	142.65
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	119.80	-0.40	-0.33%	111.75	124.28	98.23	171.65

MARKET COMMENTARY

Today, the most-traded iron ore futures contract I2601 continued to be in the doldrums, closing at 769, down 0.19% from yesterday. Traders showed a moderate willingness to sell; steel mills purchased as needed, with few inquiries. The market transaction atmosphere was average. Due to the extended vehicle control period, some steel mills have increased their transportation of materials from ports to their premises. In Shandong, the mainstream transaction prices for PB fines were around 765-768 yuan/mt, down 2-5 yuan/mt from yesterday; in Tangshan, the transaction prices for PB fines were around 775-780 yuan/mt, down 5 yuan/mt from yesterday.

According to an SMM survey, on August 20, the operating rate of blast furnaces at 242 steel mills tracked by SMM was 86.27%, down 0.22 percentage points MoM. The daily average hot metal production of the sample steel mills was 2.4125 million mt, up 0.02 million mt MoM. This week, domestic blast furnaces mainly resumed production. Next week, steel mill production will remain relatively stable, with limited fluctuations in hot metal output. However, due to environmental protection-driven production restrictions for the military parade, some steel mills will gradually schedule maintenance at month-end. According to SMM's current tracking, overall hot metal production is expected to decline significantly, putting pressure on iron ore prices and leading to a weak and volatile market.

IRON ORE PORT LUMP INDEX (IOPLI)

Week Ending Aug 15th, 2025		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [3]						
Index	Fe Content	Price	W-o-W	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]	Price	W-oW	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOPLI62	62.5% Fe Lump	920	2	0.2%	899	972	820	1210	115.20	0.26	0.23%	112.01	121.86	102.77	153.57

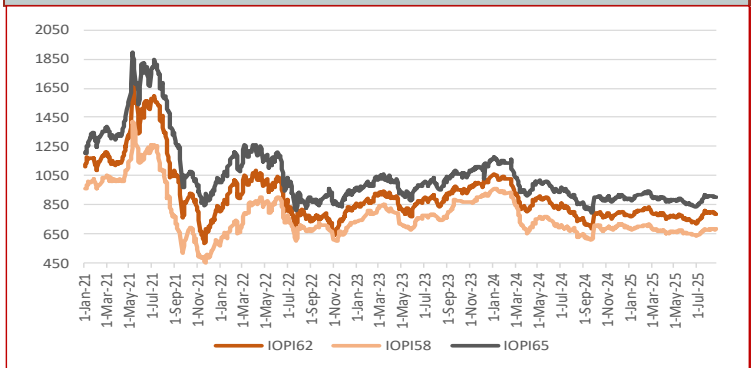
IRON ORE DOMESTIC CONCENTRATE SPOT PRICE ASSESSMENTS AND COMPOSITE INDEX

Week Ending Aug 15th, 2025				RMB/tonne (excluding tax) [3]				USD/tonne (excluding tax) [3]			
Province	Region	Product	Basis	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
Hebei	Hanxing	66% Fe Concentrate	Dry	912	0.7%	859	1226	127.77	0.67%	119.88	172.59
Hebei	Qian'an	65% Fe Concentrate	Dry	990	4.2%	880	1300	138.70	4.22%	122.81	183.23
Liaoning	Anshan	65% Fe Concentrate	Wet	730	1.4%	690	970	102.27	1.39%	96.49	136.72
Shandong	Zibo	65% Fe Concentrate	Dry	938	0.8%	878	1294	131.42	0.76%	122.53	182.16

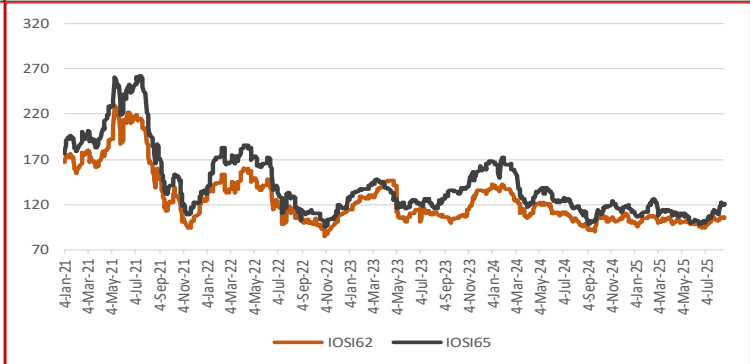
Week Ending Aug 15th, 2025	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
China Mines Concentrate Composite Index RMB/WT	865.14	2.23%	802.20	905.40

[1] Exchange rate applied: RMB/USD = 7.191 [2] Last 12 months
[3] Weekly exchange rate applied: RMB/USD =7.19258

IRON ORE PORT INDEX, FOT QINGDAO (RMB/WT)



IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX, CFR QINGDAO (USD/DMT)



IRON ORE PORT STOCK INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Aug 21st, 2025		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	April	May	June	July	MTD	QTD	YTD	April	May	June	July	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOPI62	62% Fe Fines	771	770	738	772	**780**	774	837	99.27	99.19	95.15	100.15	**100.88**	100.21	108.98
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	664	668	650	664	**680**	675	731	85.93	86.44	84.27	86.58	**88.39**	87.78	95.78
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	883	882	850	884	**892**	886	948	114.18	114.14	110.12	115.17	**115.87**	115.23	124.01

IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Aug 21st, 2025		CFR Qingdao, USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	April	May	June	July	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOSI62	62% Fe Fines	101.62	100.10	96.53	100.49	**102.00**	101.22	110.07
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	109.70	105.43	100.81	106.81	**111.75**	111.15	124.28

FREIGHT RATES

Aug 20th, 2025		FREIGHT RATES - DRY BULK US$/wet tonne				
Route	Designation		Change	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
W. Australia - Qingdao	C5	9.18	-0.35	-3.7%	5.92	14.89
Tubarao - Qingdao	C3	23.73	-0.53	-2.2%	16.08	35.02

IRON ORE PORT LUMP INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Week Ending Aug 15th, 2025		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [1]						
Index	Fe Content	April	May	June	July	MTD	QTD	YTD	April	May	June	July	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOPLI62	62.5% Fe Lump	901	898	865	907	**899**	893	972	111.81	111.39	107.50	113.27	**112.01**	111.35	121.86

IRON ORE INDEX PREMIUMS/DISCOUNTS

Aug 21st, 2025		PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)	
Index	Fe Content	Spread to IOPI62	% Spread to IOPI62
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	**-108**	-13.67%
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	**112**	14.18%

Aug 21st, 2025		SEABORNE INDEX (USD/DMT)	
Index	Fe Content	Spread to IOSI62	% Spread to IOSI62
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	**14.80**	14.10%

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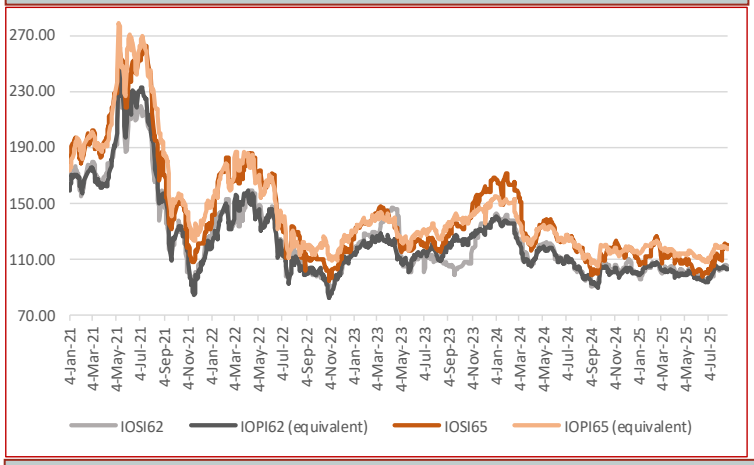
IRON ORE INDEX COMPARISONS (USD/DMT)



CHINA DOMESTIC COMPOSITE MINES INDEX (RMB/Wet Tonne, including VAT)

IRON ORE BRAND SPOT PRICE ASSESMENTS

Aug 21st, 2025	PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOPI62
Roy Hill	733	1	-57
SIMEC Fines	661	1	-129
PB Fines	759	1	-31
Newman Fines	758	1	-32
MAC Fines	740	1	-50
Jimblebar Blended Fines	654	1	-136
Carajas Fines	970	1	180
Brazilian SSF	752	1	-38
Brazilian Blend Fines	772	1	-18
RTX Fines	673	1	-117
West Pilbara Fines	702	1	-88

Aug 21st, 2025	SEABORNE INDEX (USD/DMT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOSI62
Roy Hill	100.50	0.30	-4.50
SIMEC Fines	97.00	0.30	-8.00
PB Fines	101.25	0.30	-3.75
Newman Fines	104.13	0.28	-0.88
MAC Fines	101.25	0.30	-3.75
Jimblebar Blended Fines	93.65	0.30	-11.35
Carajas Fines	134.55	0.30	29.55
Brazilian SSF	108.75	0.30	3.75
Brazilian Blend Fines	110.35	0.30	5.35
RTX Fines	94.85	0.30	-10.15
West Pilbara Fines	99.25	0.30	-5.75

Aug 21st, 2025	PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOPI58
SSF	682	1	0
FMG Blended Fines	690	1	8
Robe River	691	1	9
Western Fines	694	1	12
Atlas Fines	688	1	6
Yandi	676	1	-6

IRON ORE INDEX NORMALISATION DIFFERENTIALS

Port Stock Index Product Differentials (RMB/wet tonne)

	Applicable range	Value	Change
1% Fe	High Grade Fe 60 - 63%	5.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 63 - 64%	11.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 64 - 65%	11.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 65 - 65.5%	11.00	0.00
	Low Grade Fe	24.00	0.00
1% Alumina	High Fe Grade Al <2.25%	5.00	0.00
	High Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	12.00	2.00
	Low Fe Grade Al <2.25%	70.00	5.00
	Low Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	22.00	-2.00
1% Silica	High Fe Grade Si <4%	5.00	0.00
	High Fe Grade Si 4-6.5%	45.00	5.00
	Low Fe Grade	20.00	0.00
0.01% Phosphorus	High Fe Grade 0.09%<P<0.115%	5.00	0.00
	High Fe Grade 0.115%<P<0.15%	5.00	0.00
	Low Fe Grade 0.09<P<0.1%	5.00	0.00

Seaborne Index Product Differentials (USD/dry tonne)

	Applicable range	Value	Change
1% Fe	High Grade Fe 60 - 63%	2.75	-0.25
	High Grade Fe 63 - 64%	2.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 64 - 65%	2.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 65 - 65.5%	2.00	0.00
1% Alumina	High Fe Grade Al <2.25%	3.25	0.25
	High Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	3.25	0.25
1% Silica	High Fe Grade Si <4%	2.75	0.00
	High Fe Grade Si 4 - 6.5%	3.75	0.00
0.01% Phosphorus	High Fe Grade 0.09%<P<0.115%	1.00	0.00
	High Fe Grade 0.115%<P<0.15%	0.75	0.00

Port Stock Price Differentials to Qingdao Port for PB Fines (RMB/wet tonne)

Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change
Bayuquan	-50.00	0.00	Fangcheng	-25.00	0.00	Lanshan	0.00	0.00	Rizhao	0.00	0.00
Beilun	0.00	0.00	Jiangyin	-20.00	0.00	Lianyungang	-5.00	0.00	Shekou	0.00	0.00
Caofeidian	-10.00	0.00	Jingtang	-15.00	0.00	Majishan	0.00	0.00	Taicang	-20.00	0.00
Dalian	0.00	0.00	Lanqiao	0.00	0.00	Qingdao	0.00	0.00	Tianjin	-10.00	0.00

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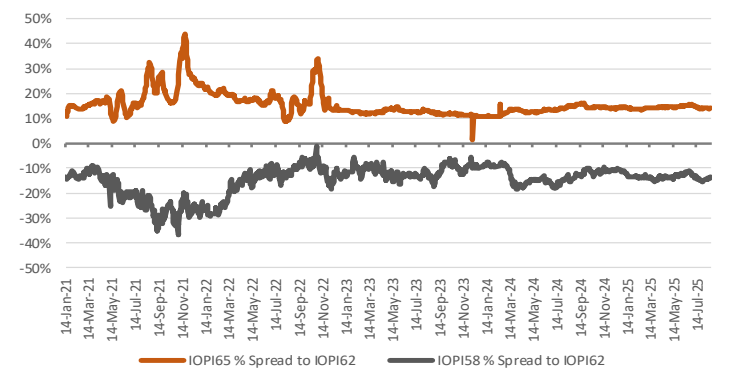
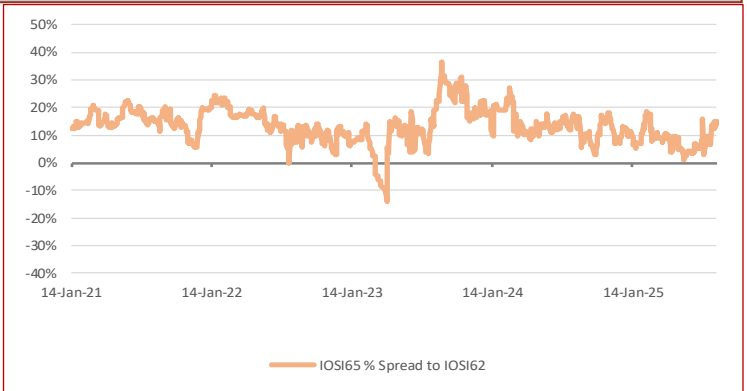
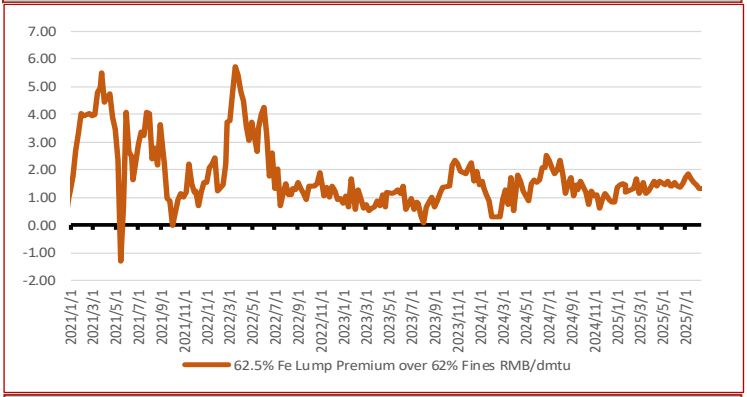
IRON ORE INDEX PREMIUMS/DISCOUNTS

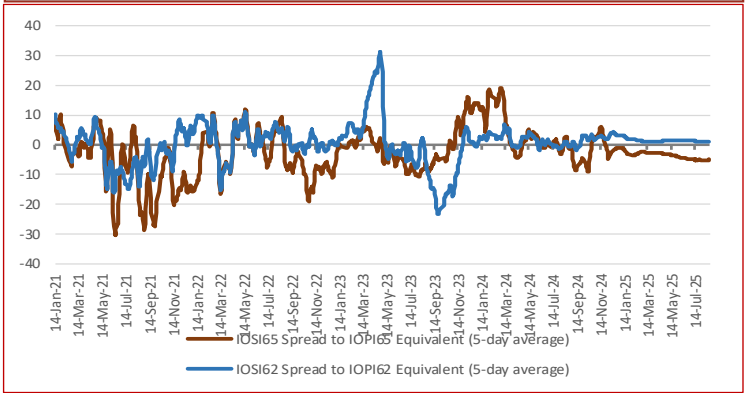




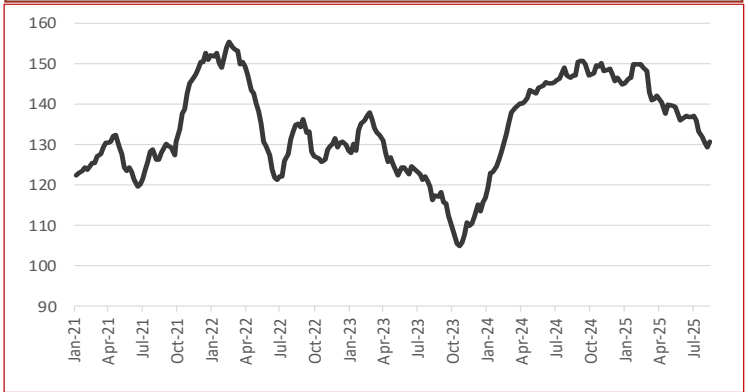
WEEKLY IRON ORE PORT STOCK LUMP PREMIUM (RMB/DMTU)



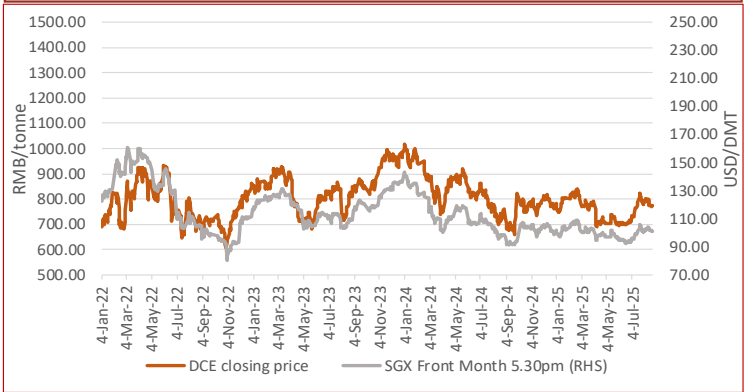
IRON ORE SEABORNE TO PORT STOCK PRICE SPREADS (USD/DMT)



TOTAL IRON ORE INVENTORIES AT CHINA PORTS (MILLION TONNES)



FUTURE TRADING—FRONT MONTH CLOSING PRICE



IRON ORE PORT INVENTORIES (MILLION TONNES)

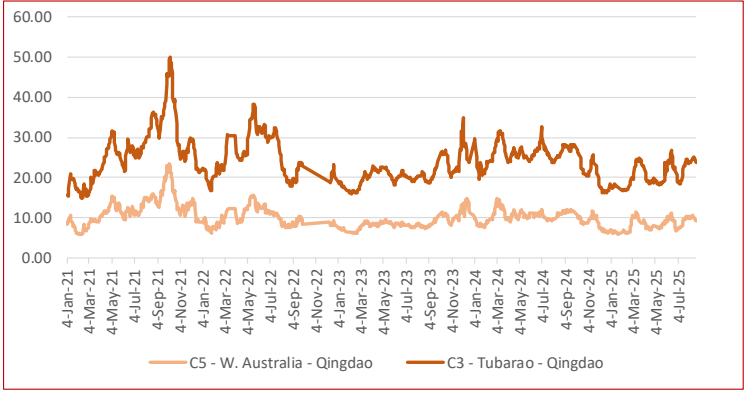
Week Ending Aug 15th, 2025

Province	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
Jingtang	13.61	-3.68%	8.29	17.20
Qingdao	27.78	-0.36%	22.28	28.75
Caofeidian	14.27	3.26%	7.56	20.28
Tianjin	9.28	-4.13%	6.64	12.36
Rizhao	14.03	-0.71%	11.52	21.35
Total (35 Ports)	130.67	1.08%	105.01	150.72

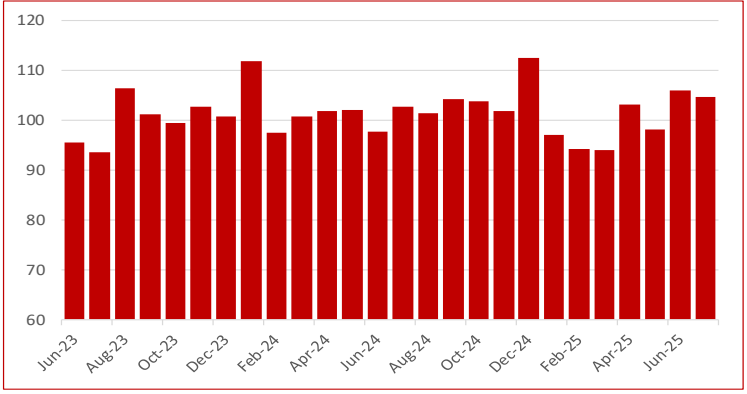
IRON ORE FUTURES CONTRACTS

	DCE (RMB/WMT)			SGX (USD/DMT)		
Closing Date	Aug 21st, 3pm close			Aug 21st, 5:30pm		
Contract	I2601	Change	Change %	Sep. 25	Change	Change %
Closing Price	772.50	3.50	0.46%	101.20	0.50	0.50%
Vol traded ('000 lots)	28.18	-0.76	-2.63%	9.18	-2.89	-23.92%
Open positions ('000 lots)	45.16	1.12	2.54%	40.51	-3.77	-8.51%
Day Low	770.0	10.00	1.32%	101.00	0.95	0.95%
Day High	780.0	7.50	0.97%	102.30	0.90	0.89%

DRY BULK FREIGHT RATES (USD/MT)



TOTAL CHINA IRON ORE IMPORT VOLUMES (MILLION TONNES)



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STEEL SPOT MARKET PRICES—CHINA

Steel Spot Market RMB/tonne

Product	2025/08/15	Change	Change %
ReBar HRB400 ϕ18mm	3,250	-20	-0.61%
Wirerod Q300 ϕ6.5mm	3,410	-20	-0.59%
HRC Q235/SS400 5.5mm*1500*C	3,466	12	0.34%
CRC SPCC/ST12 1.0mm*1250*2500	3,897	20	0.52%
Medium & Heavy Plate Q235B 20mm	3,527	0	0.00%
GI ST02Z 1.0mm*1000*C	4,375	-20	-0.46%
Colour Coated Plate	6,700	50	0.75%

CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY

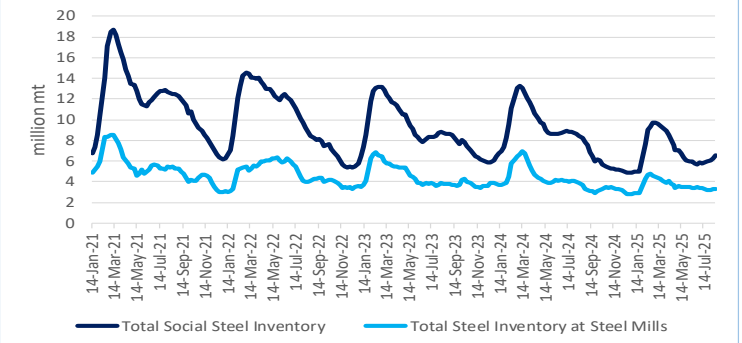
SMM Tracking of Steel Mill P&L - Rebar and Hot-rolled Coil (RMB/tonne)

Category	Price	Change (WoW)	Note
MMi (Fe 62%), USD/mt exluding tax	103.51	0.02	Mmi CFR Equivalent index for 1st Feb
Coke	1,605	0	2nd grade met coke, Tangshan, incl. tax
Steel Scrap	2,490	0	steel scrap (6mm) in Zhangjiagang, exl. tax
Billet Cost	2,552	-1	Q234, incl. tax
Rebar cost - Blast furnace	3,110	-1	calculated based on theoretical weight, incl. tax
Rebar profit - Blast furnace	140	-19	based on Shanghai prices, incl. tax
Hot-rolled coil cost - Blast furnace	3,187	0	based on actual weight, incl. tax
Hot-rolled coil proft - Blast furnace	283	10	based on Shanghai prices, incl. tax

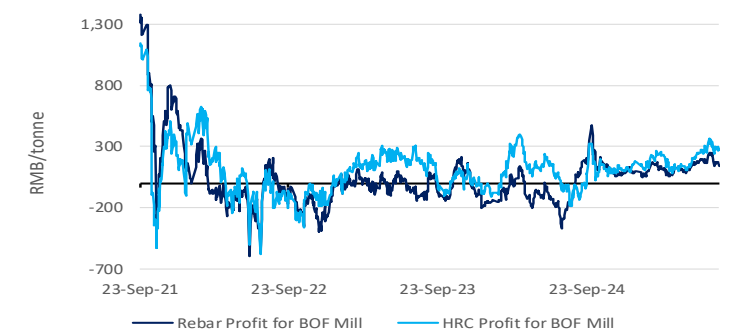
Note: 1. Costs in the table are caluclated based on todays market prices and facout our management, sales, financial and depreciations fe

2. The cost refers to average cost in the industry based on SMM's survey of small, medium and large mills in China

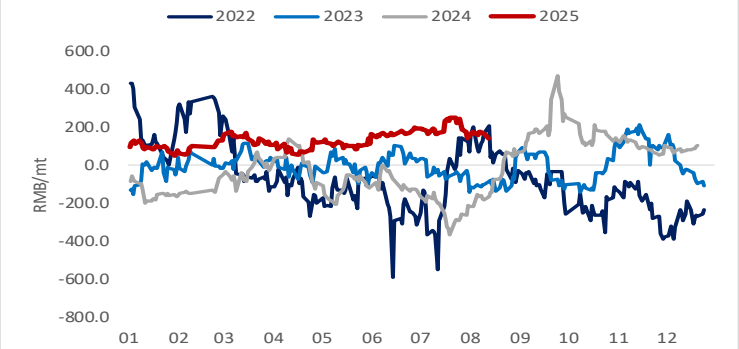
CHINESE STEEL INVENTORIES



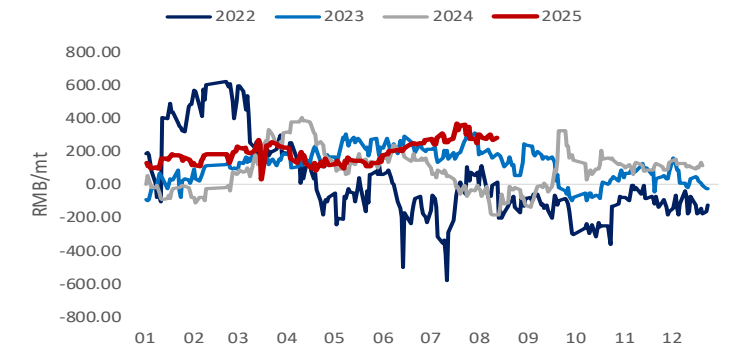
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY



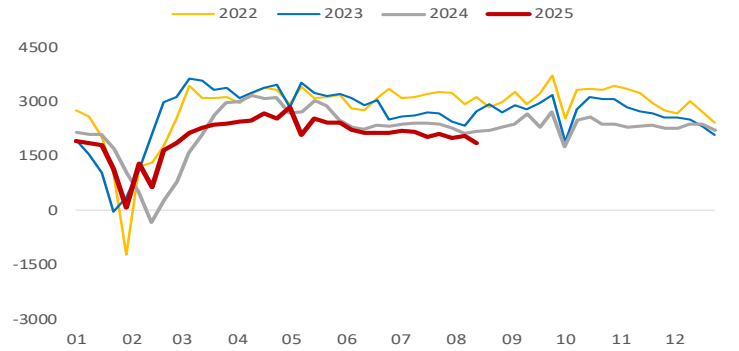
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY—Rebar



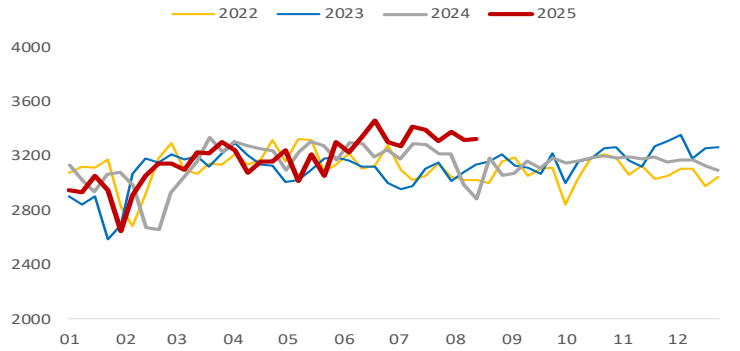
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY—Hot-rolled Coil



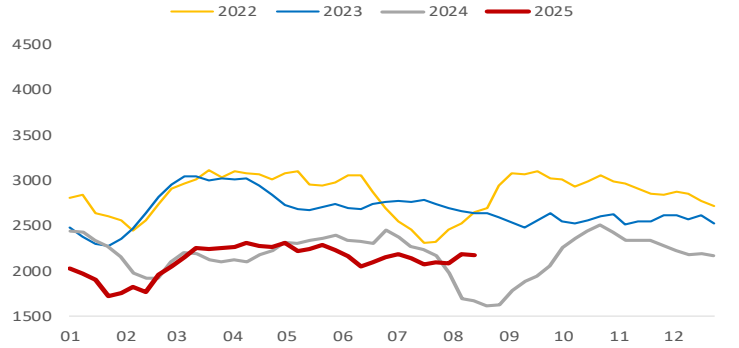
CHINESE STEEL CONSUMPTION—Rebar



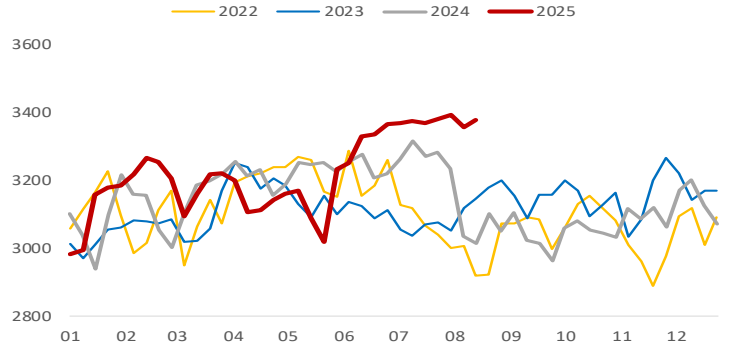
CHINESE STEEL CONSUMPTION—Hot-rolled Coil



CHINESE STEEL PRODUCTION—Rebar



CHINESE STEEL PRODUCTION—Hot-rolled Coil



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IRON ORE INDEX SPECIFICATIONS, COMPILATION RATIONALE AND DATA EXCLUSIONS

Iron Ore Index Specifications (Port and Seaborne)

	65% Fe Fines	62% Fe Fines	58% Fe Fines	62.5% Fe Lump
Fe %	65.00	62.00	58.00	62.50
Alumina %	1.40	2.25	2.25	1.50
Silica%	1.50	4.00	5.50	3.50
Phosphorus %	0.06	0.09	0.05	0.08
Sulphur %	0.01	0.02	0.02	0.02
Moisture %	8.00	8.00	9.00	4.00
Sizing	Granular size below 10mm for at least 90% of cargo; maximum of 40% below 150 micron			Size below 6.3mm max 15% Size above 31.15mm max 25%
Pricing Point	Qingdao Port (FOT and CFR respectively)			FOT Qingdao Port
Timing (Seaborne)	Loading within 4 weeks, Delivery within 8 weeks			Delivery within 2 weeks
Payment Terms	L/C at sight			L/C at sight or CAD

Iron Ore Index Compilation Rationale and Data Exclusions

MMi iron ore indices are compiled from data provided by companies that are part of the iron ore supply chain and involved in spot market transactions. The indices are calculated using detailed transaction-level data submitted to MMi by these companies. This data is normalised to the appropriate specifications and screened to remove outliers before volume-weighted average prices are calculated from the remaining core set of data.

Data Exclusions*

	62%	58%	65%
Port Index	0	0	0
Seaborne index	0		0
Lump Index 62.5	0		

* Number of price submissions for iron ore indices that were excluded from index calculations today as they were anomalous and could not be verified

IRON ORE DOMESTIC CONCENTRATE INDEX CALCULATION METHODOLOGY

The compilation method for price index generally refers to the compilation method of CPI price index and other price indices, breakdown the price data and calculate the average value according to a certain method, taking the vertical axis as the regional composite index (average of different grade index) and the horizontal axis as the grade composite index (average of different regional index), a total composite index for domestic ore can be output ultimately. The process system is also adopted in the calculation i.e. each sub-index can be obtained as well.

AVERAGE IRON ORE SPECIFICATIONS APPLIED FOR BRAND PRICE ASSESSMENTS

PORT STOCK BRANDS

Aug 21st, 2025	Specifications applied for 62% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
Roy Hill	60.88%	2.35%	4.45%	0.055%	9.26%
SIMEC Fines	60.00%	2.30%	6.30%	0.060%	6.00%
PB Fines	61.64%	2.31%	3.87%	0.099%	9.45%
Newman Fines	62.49%	2.31%	3.98%	0.090%	7.72%
MAC Fines	60.43%	2.38%	4.64%	0.078%	7.57%
Jimblebar Blended Fines	60.87%	2.95%	4.53%	0.111%	7.32%
Carajas Fines	64.90%	1.39%	1.82%	0.080%	7.78%
Brazilian SSF	62.00%	1.00%	6.50%	0.040%	6.00%
Brazilian Blend Fines	62.56%	1.58%	4.79%	0.091%	8.72%
RTX Fines	61.00%	3.10%	4.50%	0.135%	7.50%
West Pilbara Fines	60.10%	2.30%	4.70%	0.075%	8.50%

Aug 21st, 2025	Specifications applied for 58% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
SSF	56.49%	3.20%	6.19%	0.065%	9.18%
FMG Blended Fines	58.20%	2.43%	5.54%	0.057%	8.29%
Robe River	56.44%	3.16%	5.73%	0.042%	8.44%
Western Fines	57.88%	2.87%	7.50%	0.062%	7.45%
Atlas Fines	58.00%	1.85%	5.50%	0.090%	9.00%
Yandi	56.87%	1.58%	6.41%	0.042%	9.53%

SEABORNE BRANDS

	Specifications applied for 62% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
Roy Hill	60.70%	2.30%	4.90%	0.055%	8.00%
SIMEC Fines	60.00%	2.30%	6.30%	0.060%	6.00%
PB Fines 62%	62.00%	2.60%	4.30%	0.090%	9.50%
Newman Fines	62.30%	2.40%	4.40%	0.090%	8.00%
MAC Fines	60.80%	2.35%	4.70%	0.080%	7.80%
Jimblebar Blended Fines	60.50%	3.00%	4.50%	0.120%	8.00%
Carajas Fines	65.10%	1.50%	1.70%	0.080%	8.50%
Brazilian SSF	62.00%	1.00%	6.50%	0.040%	6.00%
Brazilian Blend Fines	63.00%	1.50%	5.00%	0.070%	7.00%
RTX Fines	61.00%	3.10%	4.50%	0.135%	7.50%
West Pilbara Fines	60.10%	2.30%	4.70%	0.075%	8.50%

BLOOMBERG TICKERS

PORT STOCK INDICES

	FOT Qingdao (RMB/wet tonne)	CFR Qingdao Equivalent (USD/dry tonne)
IOPI62	IRCNQ001	IRCNQ004
IOPI58	IRCNQ002	IRCNQ005
IOPI65	IRCNQ003	IRCNQ006
IOPLI62	IRCN0036	IRCN0037

SEABORNE INDICES

	CFR Qingdao (USD/DMT)
IOSI62	IRCN0034
IOSI65	IRCN0035

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